

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2

PAPER 2 June 2024

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to June 2024 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) – Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

The leftover passenger Baba VaShingi had driven the same kombi for eleven years, the one with a door that needed a shoulder and a radio that knew only two stations. He did not like children who ate simba chips and wiped their hands on his seats, but he liked children who said good morning, which, he claimed, was becoming rare as winter rain. On a Tuesday that smelled of dust and overripe mangoes, a small boy remained on the back seat after the last rank at Town House. “Where is your mother?” Baba VaShingi asked. The boy looked at him as if the question were in another language. He held a plastic bag with a maths book and an orange. The conductor had already gone to buy sadza. For a moment the driver felt the old temptation to be only a driver, not an uncle to the whole city. Then he locked the doors from the inside, because the rank had its own weather, and phoned the number written in biro on the book’s first page. No one answered. He tried again. A woman picked up on the fourth attempt, voice sharp with the fear of people who work far from their children. “He was supposed to get off at Copacabana.” Baba VaShingi looked at the boy, who had begun to peel the orange as if that were a kind of prayer. “I will bring him,” he said. “Do not pay another kombi to panic.” They drove against the flow of knocking-off traffic. The boy offered him a piece of orange. He refused, then accepted, because refusal can sound like anger. At the gate of a block of flats in Eastlea, the woman was already waiting, shoes in her hand, as if she had run the last stretch. She tried to press extra money on him. He shook his head. “Teach him to speak,” he said, not unkindly. “The city is loud. A quiet child is easily leftover.” He climbed back into the kombi. The door needed a shoulder. The radio found, miraculously, a third station.

2. (a) What first tells Baba VaShingi that something is wrong? [2]<<
>>(b) What inner conflict does he experience before he helps the boy? [3]<<
>>(c) How does the writer show the mother's fear? [3]<<
>>(d) Why does he accept the orange after first refusing? [3]<<
>>(e) Explain "a quiet child is easily leftover" in your own words. [4]<<
>>(f) What is suggested by the radio finding a third station at the end? [5] **[20]**
3. Summarise in not more than 160 words what Baba VaShingi does when he finds the boy and what he tells the mother. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. A librarian asks you to lower your voice. You say: **[2]**

- A) Make me.
- B) This is a free country.
- C) Sorry, I'll be quieter.
- D) Other people are louder.

5. Your little brother spills tea on a visitor. You say to the visitor: **[2]**

- A) I'm so sorry. Let me fetch a cloth.
- B) You should have moved.
- C) He's always clumsy.
- D) It's only tea.

6. A classmate borrows your pen and does not return it. You say: **[2]**

- A) Buy your own, beggar.
- B) I'm telling the whole school.
- C) You always steal.
- D) May I have my pen back, please? I need it for the next lesson.

7. A shop assistant short-changes you. The appropriate register is: **[2]**

- A) Whatever, keep it, poor people.
- B) Give me my money before I call the police, now!
- C) You thieves!
- D) Excuse me, I think the change is not correct. Could we check, please?

8. You bump into a teacher who is carrying a pile of books. The most appropriate thing to say is: **[2]**

- A) Sorry, Sir/Madam. Let me help you with those.
- B) Move, I was here first.
- C) Those books are too many anyway.
- D) Watch where you're going!

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).